



Matobev

Product, Screens & Design

What the product is, the market it is entering, every screen from splash to logout, an honest assessment of what people will and will not like, and a design direction argued from first principles.

Prepared for Simeon Odhiambo

Scope 44 screens · player and scout roles

Date 20 August 2026

Status Pre-launch · Android build passing · not yet used end to end

The four findings that matter

If you read nothing else, read these. Two of them are uncomfortable.

1. The concept is not novel, and the AI is not the differentiator

Matobev is entering a market with at least six direct competitors, several better funded. **Scout Me Pro** is nearly identical in positioning — "TikTok for football", AI video analysis, computer-vision performance scores, players aged 13+ with parental-consent support, scouts with advanced filters, free to start. **Afriskaut** relaunched in 2025 at the Viareggio Cup and is in talks with the NBA. **SOCALOCA** has a partnership with the Ghana Football Association. ScoutMe, Scoutfutbol and Afriq Foot Scout all occupy the same sentence.

Every one of them claims AI analysis. Matobev's engine currently scores four attributes and is *uncertain about all of them*. As a differentiator, "we have AI" is already table stakes and Matobev is behind on it.

2. The real opening is trust, and it is enormous

The documented problem in African football is not that talent goes unseen. It is that **tens of thousands of young players a year are defrauded and trafficked** by people posing as agents. Families pay for trials that do not exist. Players arrive abroad, have documents and phones seized, and are forced to extract more money from home. This is reported by ISS Africa, ENACT, VICE and others, and the recommended remedies are consistently about *verification and publishing who is genuine*.

WHERE MATOBEV IS GENUINELY AHEAD

Not one competitor positions on safety. Matobev already enforces guardian consent in the database, hides under-18 profiles from the open internet, enforces blocking in row-level security, and states in its terms that **nobody may ever ask a player for money**. That is a real position in a market defined by confident AI claims and a documented trafficking problem — and most of it is already built.

3. The honesty about uncertainty is the product's best idea

Every competitor sells a confident "performance score". Matobev marks confidence, mutes low-confidence values, and refuses to declare a winner in a comparison it cannot support. That is unusual, defensible, and impossible to copy without admitting your own numbers are soft.

It is also the harder sell. A scout skimming a store listing wants a number. Matobev's pitch has to be *"the ratings you can trust because we tell you when not to"* — which is a better long-term position and a worse screenshot.

4. It has not been used, and it shows

In one ninety-second review, three defects surfaced: a scout could not play a player's video at all, the back button was invisible on a light photo, and the leaderboard offered scouts a filter on a position scouts do not have. None are subtle. All three survived because the app was verified by typechecks and bundles rather than by a person using it as a scout.

What Matobev is

A talent-discovery platform for African footballers. A player uploads a highlight from their phone; software analyses how they move and produces a rating with a confidence attached; scouts search, watch, shortlist and make contact.

The problem

Discovery in African football runs on physical presence and personal networks — being at the right academy, knowing someone, being able to travel. Each is a filter on circumstance rather than ability. Into that gap steps a large, organised fraud industry selling the one thing families will pay for: hope.

Who it serves

Role	Actually wants	Gets
Player 13+, mostly 15–21	Proof that someone real is looking	Profile, rating, scout visibility, open trials, and evidence of attention
Scout clubs, academies, agents	To avoid wasting a journey	Filtered search, ratings as a first pass, footage, shortlists, notes, contact, trials
Guardian of an under-18	To know their child is not being exploited	A consent decision they make themselves, and the ability to withdraw it

The guardian is a genuine third user, not an afterthought. They never install the app — they receive a link. That is the only screen in the product built for someone who is not a user.

The two loops the product depends on

Player loop: upload → get rated → be seen → be told someone looked → upload again. It breaks if nothing ever comes back. That is why "a scout viewed your profile", "your rating went up" and the weekly summary exist, and why the improvement leaderboard is the default board — a rating-sorted list tells the bottom 90% they are nowhere.

Scout loop: filter → skim → watch → shortlist → contact. It breaks at *watch* if footage is slow, unplayable, or not worth the data. For a scout on mobile data, every video that turns out to be useless is money.

What people will like, and what they will not

Written as bluntly as I can. The second column is the one worth arguing with.

Players

Will like	Will not
Being told a scout looked at them. This is the single most emotionally valuable thing the app does, and it is already built.	A low rating. A 16 out of 99 on a scale they read fluently from FIFA reads as a verdict on them as a person. The confidence marker helps, but a teenager will remember the number.
Free, with nobody asking for money. In this market that is not a feature, it is a relief.	Uploading a video on mobile data and getting nothing back. The upload is the single most expensive action in the app, in real money.
The improvement board. A category they can actually top.	Being asked for a guardian. Correct, necessary, and a real drop-off point. Some will lie about their age instead.
The rating reveal moment. The one orchestrated moment; it is what gets screenshotted and shared.	Waiting. Analysis is not instant, and "processing" with no estimate feels broken on a slow connection.

Scouts

Will like	Will not
Filters that match how they think — position, age band, region, minimum rating.	Ratings they cannot interrogate. A scout will not trust a number without knowing what produced it. The breakdown exists; it must be one tap away, not three.
Notes and folders. Unglamorous and the reason a scout returns.	Thin inventory. A scouting app with 40 players is not worth opening twice. This is the hardest problem the product has.
Confidence markers — once explained. It tells them which numbers to ignore, which saves journeys.	Verification friction before they can see anything of value.

THE THING NOBODY WILL SAY OUT LOUD

The cold-start problem is the real risk, not the design. Players join because scouts are there; scouts join because players are there. Every competitor listed in this document is fighting the same fight, and two of them have federation partnerships. **A design document cannot solve this.** Seeding one region, one age group, or one academy relationship properly matters more than any screen in Part Four.

Every screen, splash to logout

Forty-four screens. Each entry gives its purpose, how it is reached, where it leads, what is on it, its empty and error states, and what to watch for.

A · Cold start

Splash		native · expo-splash-screen
Holds the first frame while fonts, session and theme resolve, so the app never flashes an unstyled screen.		
Shows	Logo at 220px on white; #0A1628 in dark mode	
Leads to	Index, once ready	
Watch out	On a 1–2 GB device this is where a slow cold start is felt. It is dismissed manually, so any error before <code>hideAsync()</code> leaves the user staring at a logo.	

Index — routing gate		index
Decides where a launch lands. No UI of its own.		
Decides between	Welcome · onboarding · verify-email · profile completion · player tabs · scout tabs · suspended	
Inputs	Session, email-verified flag, role, profile-completed flag, suspension state	
Watch out	Every routing bug in the app lands here. It is also the only place that can trap a user in a loop.	

Welcome		welcome
First screen a signed-out visitor sees.		
Elements	Brand, one-line proposition, <i>Create account</i> , <i>Sign in</i> , <i>Browse without an account</i>	
Leads to	Signup · login · browse	
Watch out	This screen carries the entire first impression and currently sells features rather than the outcome. "Get seen by scouts" beats "AI-powered analysis".	

Onboarding		onboarding
Three slides: upload → analysis → scouts.		
Elements	Full-bleed imagery, headline per slide, skip, final CTA	
Leads to	Browse or signup	
Watch out	Skippable and skipped. Anything load-bearing must not live only here.	

Browse (signed out)

browse

Shows real players before asking for anything — the strongest argument the app can make.

Elements	Player cards with name, position, country, rating badge
Empty	Nothing to show yet — falls back to a sign-up prompt
Any action	Prompts sign-up with a reason naming the action
Safety	Adults only. Under-18 profiles are excluded in the database view, not hidden in the UI

B · Account creation

Role select

role-select

Player or scout. Irreversible.

Watch out	The role is immutable in the database. The screen must say so before the tap, not after — a scout who meant to be a player currently needs a new account.
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Sign up

signup

Email, password, and acceptance of both legal documents.

Elements	Email, password, confirm, two acceptance checkboxes with in-app links to the Terms and Privacy Policy
Errors	Duplicate email, weak password, network failure
Watch out	Until this week the two document links were styled as links and did nothing — people accepted documents they could not open.

Log in · Forgot password · Verify email

login · forgot-password · verify-email

Return, recover, and confirm.

Elements	Credentials; reset by email; a hold screen with resend
Watch out	Verification email deliverability to Gmail on mobile is the most common silent drop-off in this flow.

Profile completion

profile-complete

The four fields the database actually requires, plus optional depth.

Required	Full name · date of birth · nationality · primary position
Optional	Height, weight, club, foot, jersey, bio, socials, photo
Age logic	Under 13 blocked outright; 13–17 flagged for guardian consent
Watch out	The longest form in the app and the last thing between a user and value. Every optional field here costs completions.

C · Player tabs

Home

(player-tabs)/home

The player's standing, and the one thing to do next.

Elements	Greeting, header actions, rating card , upload prompt, three quick actions, upcoming trials, recent activity
Loading	Screen-shaped skeleton matching the real layout
Empty	No rating yet → the card invites a first upload rather than showing a zero
Watch out	The rating card is the emotional centre of the product. It is also where a low number does the most damage.

Reels

(player-tabs)/reels

Vertical highlight feed — the habit surface.

Elements	Full-bleed video, player overlay, like · save · comment · share
Loading	Spinner, deliberately not a skeleton — grey blocks on black interrupt more than they help
Watch out	The most data-hungry screen in the app. Autoplay on mobile data is a real cost decision, not a UX preference.

Upload

(player-tabs)/upload

The core contribution. Also the most expensive action a player takes.

Steps	Pick clip → choose <i>highlight</i> or <i>AI analysis</i> → tag yourself in one frame → title, match, opponent, tags → publish
Guards	Size checked before transfer; guardian consent checked before a byte is uploaded; failed row insert deletes the orphaned file
Watch out	Self-tagging is the least obvious step and the one the analysis depends on most. If it is skipped or wrong, the rating is wrong and the player blames themselves.

Discover

(player-tabs)/discover

Other players, search, trending, news.

Elements	Search bar, filter chips, sort, player rows, news strip
Empty	No matches → widen-filters prompt
Watch out	Player-to-player browsing is social, not functional. It competes with Reels for the same attention and may not deserve a tab.

Profile (own)

(player-tabs)/profile

What a scout sees, plus what is still missing.

Tabs	About · Videos · AI Ratings · Stats
Elements	Cover, avatar, stat tiles (OVR, reels, views, invites), profile-strength meter, playable videos
Watch out	Views and invites are the numbers players check obsessively. If they are zero for weeks, this screen becomes discouraging rather than motivating.

D · Scout tabs

Dashboard

(scout-tabs)/home

A working surface, not a feed.

Elements	Verification state, search, overview counts, and four rails — Recommended, Recently Uploaded, Top Performers, Active Trials
Recommendations	Carry a real reason ("matches your preferred position", "recently active"), never a fabricated one
Watch out	Four rails of the same card is a lot of scrolling for little differentiation. Two would probably outperform four.

Players

(scout-tabs)/players

The main search surface — where a scout actually works.

Elements	Search, filter sheet (position, age, country, foot, height, weight, minimum rating), sort, compare mode
Empty	No matches → widen filters
Watch out	With thin inventory, filters return nothing and the app looks broken rather than empty. Show near-misses instead.

Trials

(scout-tabs)/trials

Post an opportunity and manage who applies.

Elements	Trial list, create form (title, club, location, positions, age range, deadline), applicant review
Watch out	This is where the platform's safety promise is tested hardest — a trial post is exactly the shape a fraudster wants.

Messages (scout) · Profile (scout)

(scout-tabs)/messages · profile

Contact, and the scout's own record.

Elements	Conversations with the anti-solicitation notice; organisation, bio, verification badge, saved-player counts
Watch out	Messaging between an adult and a minor is the highest-risk surface in the product. It deserves more friction than it has.

E · Shared destinations

Player detail

player/[id]

The assessment screen. Everything the scout decides on is here.

Elements	Cover, name, position/country/age, decision-support disclaimer, overall rating with confidence, attribute bars, playable videos , save-to-folder, private notes, follow, message, report
Empty	No videos → stated plainly; no ratings → "not analysed yet"
Watch out	Until this week the videos were not tappable. This screen is the product for a scout; it deserves the most testing.

Compare		compare
Two or more players, attribute by attribute.		
Rule	A "best" highlight is withheld when the winning value is low-confidence — the app declines to assert what it cannot support	
Watch out	Comparison invites false precision. Two uncertain numbers side by side look authoritative purely because they are adjacent.	

AI ratings		ai-ratings
The full breakdown, and the honest one.		
Elements	Hero rating, every attribute with value and confidence, analysis-job status, recommendations from the real result summary	
States	Queued · processing · completed · skipped · failed, each explained	
Watch out	This is the screen that justifies the number. It should be reachable from the rating in one tap everywhere the rating appears.	

Leaderboard		leaderboard
Ranking someone can actually place in.		
Player scopes	Most improved (default) · my region · my position · my age group	
Scout scopes	Most improved · top rated · matches my filters	
Empty	Scope-aware — "no movement yet this week" is a different statement from "not enough players here"	

Trials list · Trial detail		trials · trial/[id]
Find and apply for opportunities.		
Elements	Open trials, club, location, positions, age range, deadline, requirements, apply, application status	
Watch out	Every trial listing should carry the "never pay to attend" warning inline, not only in Help.	

Messages · Notifications · News		messages · notifications · news
Contact, signal, and announcements.		
Notification types	Scout viewed your profile · rating went up · weekly summary · trial status · invitation · analysis result · message · moderation	
Behaviour	Every notification routes to what it is about; per-category mutes and quiet hours apply	

Guardian consent

guardian-consent + web page

Where an under-18 asks a parent to approve analysis.

In app	Guardian name, email, relationship → generates a link → shared by WhatsApp or SMS
On web	The guardian opens the link, sees the player's name and the exact scopes, and confirms. Single-use; the token rotates.
Principle	A child ticking "my parent agrees" is the child consenting to themselves

Scout verification · Suspended

scout-verification · suspended

Prove you are real; or find out you are no longer welcome.

Elements	Document upload, review status; suspension reason and appeal route
Watch out	Verification is the platform's core trust claim. If it is a rubber stamp, the badge is worse than no badge.

F · Settings, and the way out

Settings hub

settings

Everything about the account, and the exit.

Rows	Account · Security · Notifications · Privacy · Blocked accounts · Language · Theme · Help — plus Parent or guardian for under-18 players
Foot	Log out · Delete account

Account · Security · Privacy

account- · security- · privacy-settings

Details, password, visibility, and permanent deletion.

Delete account	Immediate and irreversible — files removed from storage, rows cascaded. No email, no waiting period.
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Notifications · Blocked · Language · Theme · Help

notification- · blocked-accounts · language- · theme- · help-settings

Control, and the documents.

Notifications	Per-category mutes; quiet hours in local time
Blocked	Enforced in row-level security — a blocked party cannot read the other's rows at all
Language	English · French · Swahili · Portuguese
Help	FAQ, safety notice, support email, Privacy Policy and Terms in an in-app browser

Log out

[settings](#) → [logout](#)

End the session cleanly on this device.

Sequence Unregister this device's push token **first**, while the session still exists, then sign out, then clear local state, then route to Welcome

Why that order The token delete is scoped to the signed-in profile. After sign-out it would be rejected and the phone would keep receiving the previous account's notifications.

Design direction

Argued from what the product is trying to be, not from what the logo currently happens to be.

CORRECTING MY EARLIER ADVICE

An earlier version of this document built its whole colour argument on "the logo is the one asset that will not change". I assumed that; it was never established. If the logo can change — and it can — then the right question is not *what matches the mark* but *what should this product look like*, and the mark follows.

What the visual identity has to do

- 1. **Read as trustworthy, not as hype.** The competition is dark, neon and TikTok-styled. In a category where the adjacent industry is fraud, looking like a growth-hacked crypto app is an active liability.
- 2. **Be legible in sunlight on a cheap screen.** Higher contrast than a design-system default, larger body text, no thin weights.
- 3. **Make the rating feel earned but not final.** It must feel worth having and must not read as a verdict.
- 4. **Survive being one of nine icons** in a crowded store listing of blue football apps.

Two credible directions

Direction	Argument for	Argument against	Verdict
Pitch green + gold #0B6B3A · #FFC53D	Football's own colour. Instantly legible in a store listing. Warm, and differentiates hard from a market of dark blue apps. Strong resonance across African flags.	Green already means "success" in every interface convention. Using it for primary actions collides with that meaning, and this app needs a clean success state for applications and consent.	Distinctive, but it spends a semantic colour the product needs
Deep navy + gold #123A6B · #FFC53D	Institutional and calm — the register of a federation, not a startup. Leaves green and red free for outcomes. Gold on navy is the strongest pairing available at 10.93 : 1.	Navy is the most crowded palette in app stores. Without a distinctive mark it disappears.	Recommended , on the condition that the logo carries the distinctiveness

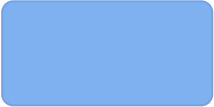
Recommendation, and what it means for the logo

Deep navy as the ground, gold as the single accent, and the logo redrawn in gold on navy. The reasoning:

- Navy is the colour of institutions people trust with children. That is the exact register a platform positioned on safety should occupy.
- Gold means *achievement* and nothing else — the rating, a rank, a milestone. One colour, one meaning, never borrowed for a button.
- It leaves green, red and amber entirely free for outcomes, which a product with applications, consent states and moderation genuinely needs.
- The current teal is not wrong, but it does two jobs at once — brand *and* primary action — and it is the reason the app and the mark currently disagree.

On the mark itself: the two figures and ball is a good silhouette and works small. The gradient is the weak part — it renders muddy at icon sizes and forces a light background. A single-colour version, gold on navy, would survive a 48px launcher icon far better and finally give the app and its logo the same palette.

Palette

				
Navy — ground #0A1B33 App bar, rating card, dark surfaces	Navy — primary #123A6B Buttons, links, active states	Primary — dark mode #7FB0F0 Same role, dark surfaces	Gold #FFC53D Achievement, on dark only	Gold — on light #8A5A00 Achievement on a light card
				
Success #1E8449 Confirmed, accepted, improved	Error #C0392B Failed, blocked, removed	Muted #6C7789 Secondary text, low confidence		

Pairing	Ratio	Verdict
Primary #123A6B on white	11.39 : 1	Passes AA as text and as a fill under white text
Primary #7FB0F0 on #0B1220	8.35 : 1	Dark-mode equivalent
Gold #FFC53D on navy #0A1B33	10.93 : 1	The rating numeral pairing
Gold #FFC53D on white	1.58 : 1	Unusable. On light, gold must darken to #8A5A00 (5.93 : 1)
Warning #B8860B on white	3.25 : 1	Fails for body text — large text or icons only

Contrast is symmetric, so foreground and background give the same ratio. The distinction that matters is *which surface*: gold is 10.93 : 1 on navy and 1.58 : 1 on white — the same colour, unusable in one of them.

Typography and depth

Role	Face	Size	Note
Rating numeral	Poppins ExtraBold	52	Gold on navy; the hero
Screen title	Poppins Bold	22–26	
Body	Poppins Regular	15–17	Never below 15 for reading text
Caption	Poppins Medium	10	The floor; nothing smaller exists

Depth: in light mode a shadow, in dark mode a progressively lighter surface, because shadows are invisible on a dark ground. The ordering must be checked numerically — hex codes do not sort by perceived lightness, and this exact ordering has been silently inverted twice in this codebase.

Proposed screens

Navy carries structure and action, gold carries achievement and appears nowhere else, and uncertainty is visible without being alarming.



Left — Player home. Gold appears once, on the rating, so it always means achievement. Navy carries the upload action. The middot after 25 and the muted 1- PAC mark low-confidence values without alarm.

Centre — Scout player detail. Confidence is stated in words as well as colour, because green/amber/red alone excludes red-green colour-blind viewers — around 8% of a scout population that skews male. Footage is prominent and playable.

Right — Leaderboard. Most improved is the default, because rating-sorted lists tell most users they are nowhere. Gains in green, ratings in navy, gold only for first place.

What I would do first

#	Action	Why
1	Walk both roles end to end on a real device	Three defects surfaced in ninety seconds this way. There will be more, and they are cheap to fix once found.
2	Decide the positioning: safety, not AI	The AI claim is table stakes and Matobev is behind on it. Safety is unclaimed and largely already built.
3	Unify the palette and redraw the mark	One token change; the app and its own logo currently disagree.
4	Solve inventory in one segment	A scouting app with thin inventory is not worth opening twice. Pick one region or age group and fill it.
5	Make the rating breakdown one tap from every rating	It is the thing that justifies the number, and the thing scouts need to trust it.

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Contrast ratios computed with the WCAG 2.1 relative-luminance formula.

Market and safeguarding context drawn from: ISS Africa and ENACT (player trafficking); VICE and Sports&Crime (fake agents); Scout Me Pro, Afriskaut, SOCALOCA, ScoutMe and Scoutfutbol (competing platforms); Google Play "next billion users" and IT News Africa (device and data constraints).